Northstar Systems Pvt. Ltd.

Comprehensive Refund and Cancellation Policy

Policy Version:	3.5
Effective Date:	September 1, 2026
Owner:	Finance, Customer Operations & Legal Compliance
Applicability:	Global (North America, EMEA, APAC, and Domestic Operations)

1. Purpose, Scope, and Policy Principles

1.1 Purpose and Intent

This Refund and Cancellation Policy governs refunds, cancellations, store credits, exchanges, billing adjustments, and payment disputes for all software licenses, physical products, cloud infrastructure, and professional services supplied by Northstar Systems Pvt. Ltd. ("the Company"). It ensures transparent, consistent handling of customer requests while balancing product delivery, service consumption models, promotional pricing, regional tax laws, and enterprise contractual commitments.

1.2 Scope and Hierarchy of Agreements

This policy applies to all direct purchases made through the company website, customer portals, approved sales channels, partner networks, and formal invoices issued by Northstar Systems.

- **Hierarchy:** If a signed Master Services Agreement (MSA), custom Enterprise Order Form, or legally mandated local consumer protection framework (e.g., EU Consumer Rights Directive, Indian Consumer Protection Act) contains terms that conflict with this policy, the specific contract terms or statutory requirements shall supersede these general guidelines.

1.3 Decision Criteria and Documentation

Refund decisions are based strictly on the immutable transaction record, activation telemetry, and the exact terms in effect at the initial point of purchase. Support representatives may request supplemental verification (such as diagnostic logs, screenshots, or unboxing evidence) when transaction records require corroboration.

2. Key Definitions

- **2.1 Refund:** A financial return of all or part of an amount previously paid by a customer, credited back strictly to the original payment instrument unless prohibited by network rules.
- **2.2 Account Credit:** A non-transferable monetary value placed on a customer account for future subscription renewals or product purchases. Credits do not constitute a cash equivalent and cannot be transferred to external bank accounts.

- **2.3 Cancellation:** The formal termination of an active order, recurring subscription, hosting reservation, or service agreement prior to the expiration of its committed term. Cancellation stops future billings but does not automatically trigger a refund.
- **2.4 Activation:** The precise timestamp at which a digital service, license key, cloud workspace, API token, or software subscription is provisioned and made available for customer deployment or access.
- **2.5 Business Day:** Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local operational time, excluding recognized national and company holidays observed by the processing team.
- **2.6 Billing Cycle:** The recurring calendar period for which subscription charges are calculated (e.g., monthly, quarterly, semi-annually, or annually).
- **2.7 Material Service Failure:** An unmitigated platform outage, critical system bug, or infrastructure failure directly attributable to Northstar Systems that breaches guaranteed Service Level Agreements (SLAs) for more than 72 consecutive hours.

3. Standard Refund Eligibility & Timeframes

3.1 The 14-Calendar-Day Standard Window

Customers may submit a formal refund request within **fourteen (14) calendar days** of an eligible standard purchase. Eligibility is contingent upon the product or service not having been substantially consumed, downloaded, or deployed, and no specific policy exclusion applying.

3.2 Extended Review Scenarios

Requests submitted outside the 14-day window will only be reviewed under exceptional operational conditions:

- Documented billing system errors or erroneous duplicate charges.
- Unfulfilled delivery or provisioning failure caused by company systems.
- Documented material service failures or prolonged system unavailability.

3.3 Consumer Safeguards

Customer dissatisfaction or failure to utilize an active service does not, by itself, establish refund eligibility. Support agents will audit activation telemetry, API call logs, license usage data, and communications history prior to rendering a decision.

4. Subscription Cancellations, Renewals, and Trials

4.1 Monthly Subscriptions

- Monthly plans may be cancelled at any time via the billing portal. Cancellation blocks the subsequent scheduled recurring charge if completed at least **24 hours prior** to the renewal timestamp.
- The current billing period remains active through its scheduled expiration date, maintaining full feature access. No partial refunds are issued for mid-cycle cancellations.

4.2 Annual Subscriptions and Multi-Year Commitments

- Annual pre-paid subscriptions remain active through the full duration of the prepaid term. Cancellation prevents auto-renewal for the subsequent year but does not yield a prorated cash refund.
- **Exceptions:** Prorated annual refunds may be granted if an enterprise contract contains a termination-for-convenience clause, the company fails to deliver contracted uptime, or local statutory regulations mandate a prorated remedy.

4.3 Trials, Proof-of-Concepts (PoCs), and Introductory Offers

- Customers must cancel active trials before the promotional period lapses to avoid automatic conversion and billing.
- Introductory promotional pricing may carry minimum-term commitments (e.g., 6-month lock-in). When promotional terms specify a minimum commitment, those terms override standard cancellation rules.

4.4 Renewal Disputes and Charge Notifications

- Customers disputing an automatic renewal charge must provide their account email, invoice identifier, charge timestamp, and justification.
- Support audits renewal notification timestamps (dispatched 30 days and 7 days prior to annual renewal) and cancellation records before processing adjustments.

5. Physical Product Returns and Hardware Logistics

5.1 General Return Conditions for Hardware

Physical hardware (such as IoT edge gateways, branded developer kits, and networking appliances) qualifies for return within **thirty (30) days** of delivery if unopened, unused, and in pristine factory packaging.

5.2 Required Components and Restocking Fees

- Returns must include all original factory accessories, power supplies, quick-start documentation, and undamaged serial number labels. Missing components or damaged outer boxes incur a mandatory **fifteen percent (15%) restocking fee**.
- Customers bear return shipping costs and transit insurance unless the item arrived defective or damaged.

5.3 Damaged Shipments and Dead-on-Arrival (DOA)

- Visible shipping damage or DOA units must be reported to support within **forty-eight (48) hours** of delivery, accompanied by photographs of the external packaging, shipping labels, and defective hardware.
- Northstar Systems will issue pre-paid return shipping labels and expedite a brand-new replacement unit upon verification.

6. Digital Products, Software Licenses, and API Access

6.1 Non-Refundable Digital Goods

Digital downloads, source code templates, compiled binaries, electronic license keys, and API access tokens are **strictly non-refundable** once the license key has been generated, downloaded, or activated, except where the item is provably defective or unprovisioned due to a system error.

6.2 Technical Defects and Troubleshooting Protocol

If a digital product exhibits a critical technical defect preventing normal operation:

1. The customer must submit diagnostic logs and error reports to technical support.
2. If engineering cannot resolve the defect within a reasonable remediation window (typically 5 business days), Northstar Systems may issue a replacement key, account credit, or direct refund.
3. License keys and account credentials must remain confidential; sharing credentials across unauthorized entities voids all refund eligibility and triggers account suspension.

7. Professional Services, Consulting, and Training

7.1 Scope of Professional Services

Consulting, architecture design, custom implementation, developer training, and data migration services are billed against defined statements of work (SOWs) and project milestones.

7.2 Refund Rules for Professional Hours

- **Unperformed Work:** Services that have not yet been scheduled, initiated, or delivered are eligible for a full refund or credit.
- **Completed Milestones:** Completed project milestones, delivered documentation, completed training workshops, and consumed consulting hours are **non-refundable**.
- **Project Termination:** If a project is cancelled mid-stream, the final settlement is calculated based on hours logged, completed milestones, third-party vendor expenses incurred, and any unearned prepaid balances returned to the client.

8. Refund Calculation, Adjustments, and Tax Treatment

8.1 Partial Refund Formulas

When partial refunds are authorized, the calculation deducts:

- The prorated value of services already consumed.
- Non-refundable onboarding, setup, or administrative fees.
- Outbound shipping costs and applicable restocking charges.

8.2 Promotional Discount Recalculation

If a partial refund drops an order's net value below a promotional bundle threshold, the discount is recalculated, and the price adjustment reflects the standard non-promotional rate for the retained items.

8.3 Taxes, VAT, and Statutory Levies

Indirect taxes (such as GST, VAT, or Sales Tax) are refunded in strict accordance with the tax jurisdiction rules governing the original transaction. Retroactive tax exemption certificates submitted more than sixty (60) days post-purchase may require the customer to reclaim taxes directly from their regional tax authority.

9. Payment Processing and Disbursement Timelines

- **9.1 Processing Window:** Once a refund is approved by finance, Northstar Systems submits the transaction to the payment gateway within **5 to 10 business days**.
- **9.2 Bank Clearing Times:** Actual posting times depend entirely on the issuing bank, credit card network, or digital wallet provider. Customers should allow up to two billing cycles for the credit to appear on their statement.
- **9.3 Unavailable Payment Methods:** If the original payment card or account has expired or been closed, support will verify identity before issuing refunds via secure wire transfer or account credit.

10. Chargebacks, Payment Disputes, and Pre-Arbitration

- **10.1 Direct Resolution Mandate:** Customers agree to contact billing support (billing@northstarsystems.io) to resolve pricing or service discrepancies before initiating a formal bank chargeback.
- **10.2 Evidence Submission:** If a chargeback or payment dispute is initiated, Northstar Systems reserves the right to submit comprehensive transaction records, server access logs, IP tracking data, signed order forms, and email correspondence to the payment processor.
- **10.3 Effect of Chargeback:** Opening a chargeback does not establish legal entitlement to a refund and will result in the immediate suspension of associated cloud infrastructure and workspace licenses pending dispute resolution.

11. Fraud Prevention, Policy Abuse, and Account Security

The company reserves the right to deny refund requests, limit service access, or permanently close accounts exhibiting indicators of:

- Fraudulent transactions or stolen payment credentials.
- Systematic policy abuse or repeated suspicious purchase-and-refund cycles.
- False delivery claims or intentional manipulation of promotional discounts.
- Unauthorized account sharing or multi-tenant license circumvention.

12. Exceptions, Special Circumstances, and Approvals

12.1 Discretionary Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy may be authorized for documented hardship, extended platform outages, or unique enterprise circumstances. Exceptions require written sign-off from a Finance Manager or Customer Operations Lead.

12.2 Non-Precedent Rule

Granting an exception for a specific transaction does not create a binding precedent or general entitlement for future purchases. Each exception is logged with an internal audit ID for compliance tracking.

13. Step-by-Step Refund Request Procedure

1. **Gather Documentation:** Collect account name, registered email address, invoice/order reference number, purchase date, product SKU, and a detailed description of the reason for the request.
2. **Submit Request:** Log into the official customer support portal (portal.northstarsystems.io/support) or submit a ticket via the authenticated billing dashboard.
3. **Internal Audit:** Support and billing teams verify transaction ledgers, delivery logs, and usage telemetry. Additional verification materials may be requested.
4. **Final Determination:** The customer receives an official notification of approval, partial approval, or denial with a detailed justification. Approved refunds begin processing immediately according to Section 9 timelines.

14. Appeals and Reconsideration Process

- If a refund request is denied and the customer possesses new or corrected information, they may file a formal appeal within **14 calendar days** of the decision notice.
- Appeals are independently reviewed by a senior support lead or finance supervisor whose decision is final.

15. Policy Administration and Version Control

This policy is maintained by the Finance and Customer Operations divisions of Northstar Systems Pvt. Ltd. Periodic amendments are published to reflect product updates, banking regulations, or legal requirements. The governing version is the one active at the exact date and time of the initial transaction.